

Client Data Room

GreenThreads Denver · Request rulings, round two · Posted September 8, 2026

Four requests came in carrying seven questions. They resolve into six rulings, numbered R-12 through R-17 and continuing from round one. Round one stands. Nothing below reopens a ruling we have already made.

Two of you asked the same question on the same day. It is answered once, at R-13, and both teams should cite it there. One request put its reasoning in the data request field and its request in the question field. We answered what was in front of us rather than what the form expected, but a request we have to reassemble is a request that gets answered slowly.

This is the last round. The room closes today and does not reopen before your readout. If a ruling in either round has a fact wrong, tell us and we will correct it. Everything else you now answer from what you hold, with your assumptions on the page, which is the work we hired you for.

A correction to round one

R-02 said we checked all twenty-one lines of the Denver budget. There are twenty. We got the count wrong. The finding holds: there is still no freight or logistics line anywhere in that budget, and inbound freight on the opening buy still has nowhere to sit except the contingency reserve or an amendment. If you carried twenty-one into your working papers, make it twenty.

The dates you are working against

This one is for all of you, and it sits underneath two of the questions in this round, so we are answering it once here rather than inside a ruling.

Today is September 8. Doors open November 1. That is 54 days.

Every data extract we sent you was pulled on July 14. The last transaction in the spend file is July 12. The last application in the applicant file is July 12. The shipment file carries goods in transit against promised dates running into August. None of those files knows anything that happened after July 14. Do not put a July figure in front of Jennifer as a current one without saying which it is.

Documents are different. A document carries its own date and is live as of that date. The Song Hong order confirmation is dated July 24, three weeks after the extract was pulled, which is exactly why it appears in none of the files you hold.

Marcus said ninety days in July, against an October opening. The date moved. The mandate did not. You have 54.

One consequence worth reading twice. We built the order-by dates in the SKU catalog backward from the old October 12 opening, with merchandise landing the day the doors opened. We did not write the ten business day receiving requirement down until R-01, which was after those dates were set. Read them as stale, the same way the Denver-LoHi label was stale. See R-16 and Appendix C.

Summary

#	Team	Request	Ruling
R-12	HR	Whether the November 1 move released additional money, and how HR should allocate it	Returned. The premise is wrong.
R-13	HR and Finance	Which budget lines belong to HR, and where the \$2.25 Sales Associate gap lands	Granted. See Appendix D.
R-14	Finance and Operations	Whether November 1 moves the Sales Associate training start	Granted.
R-15	Operations	Autumn on-time delivery data for the Vietnam lane	Declined. It does not exist.
R-16	Operations	The missing purchase order for 1,200 Active Shorts	Granted. See Appendix C.
R-17	Operations	Store street address, and receiving on October 19	Granted. See Appendix E.

R-12. The contingency reserve and the November 1 move

Returned. The question rests on a fact that is not true, and the part that survives is a decision you own.

There is no additional \$20,000. The Denver budget is \$450,000 and it did not change when the opening moved. The \$20,000 you are looking at is our contingency reserve, the last line of the budget file we sent you, and it has been there since the budget was built. Jennifer owns it. R-03 already committed up to \$7,000 of it to expedited inbound freight on her written approval, and R-02 established that unbudgeted freight on the \$110,000 opening buy has nowhere else to sit either. The reserve is spoken for before HR reaches it.

The move to November 1 bought you time, not money. It may have cost you money. If the accepted start dates hold at September 28, the pre-opening period runs about five weeks instead of two, and every one of those weeks is charged to Pre-opening payroll. See R-14.

On the half of the question that is real: yes, the plan is yours. We do not hand a function its allocation and ask it to execute. If you want to close the pay gap, hold the candidates you already have, or compress time to offer, bring it to us with a number, a source for the number, and the line it comes out of. A recommendation that names its funding line gets a decision from Jennifer. One that does not gets a question, and you will be answering it in front of Marcus.

R-13. HR budget lines and the \$2.25 Sales Associate gap

Granted. Asked by two teams on the same day and answered once.

You already hold the file. The Denver budget we sent you has twenty lines, and four of them carry an Owner_Function of HR: Recruiting and job boards at \$9,000, Pre-opening payroll at \$38,000, Training at \$11,000, and Uniforms at \$7,000. That is \$65,000, and it reconciles to the staffing and recruiting figure in the budget summary you got at kickoff. Appendix D gives budgeted, committed, and remaining for each of the four.

The contingency reserve is not an HR line. It is Jennifer's, on the conditions in R-03.

Now the part neither request framed correctly. The \$2.25 gap does not have one cost. It has two, and they land in different places.

The pre-opening cost is hours worked before the doors open. Those land in Pre-opening payroll and Training, both HR lines, with roughly \$47,000 unspent across the four as of the July 14 pull. Work it out from your own start-date assumption and it fits without touching the reserve.

The operating cost is a different animal. The \$26,208 in R-04 is an annual run rate, and the year it runs through is the store's first trading year, not the opening. Nothing in the Denver budget carries store payroll after November 1. This budget opens a store. The P&L that pays for it afterward is not a file we sent you and not a line you can charge.

So the answer to whether the gap fits inside HR's lines or draws the reserve is neither, mostly. Raising Sales Associate pay to \$19.75 is a permanent commitment against the store's margin, made inside a one-time opening budget, by a company that is not profitable yet. That is a bigger finding than a budget-line lookup, and it is the one Jennifer will reach for. Get there before she does.

One mechanical point you will need. Two Sales Associate offers are already accepted at \$17.50. A rate change either reaches those two or it does not, and if it does not you have two rates on the same floor for the same job. Tell us which, and tell us why.

R-14. Whether November 1 moves the training start

Granted.

Training is anchored to the opening, not to the calendar. Section 3.3 of the handbook requires two weeks of paid training before a store opens to the public. Two weeks before November 1 is October 19.

The September 28 date in the applicant file and in the Sales Associate offer letter is not settled. It is exactly two weeks before October 12, which was the opening date when we wrote those offers. We set it once and never went back to it, the same way nobody went back to the Denver-LoHi label in R-05. Treat it the same way.

That leaves you a choice with a price on both sides. Hold September 28 and you carry about five weeks of pre-opening payroll against a \$38,000 line instead of two. Move starts to October 19 and you already have three declines on record citing a start date too far out, and you have just pushed it three weeks further from the day those people applied.

Two things to plan around. October 19 is also the required in-store date for merchandise under R-01, so training week one runs on top of receiving, inspection under OPS-04, and floor set. That is either a training opportunity or a collision, depending on how you staff it. And the offer letters sitting in candidates' hands say September 28. Changing a start date in an accepted offer is a conversation with a person, not an edit to a spreadsheet.

R-15. Autumn delivery performance on the Vietnam lane

Declined, because it does not exist. The reasoning in the request is correct and worth saying back to you.

There is no September through November delivery history for Song Hong Apparel or Mekong Textile Co., for last year or the year before. Our inbound shipment record starts with orders placed in December 2025. There is no second year to pull and no autumn in the first one. We are not holding it back. It was never captured.

You read your own file correctly. Of its 96 rows, 80 have been received, and their promised dates run from January 15 to July 13. Not one observation falls in the season you are buying into. The 12.1 day and 6.9 day averages are a spring lane. Treating them as a floor rather than

an expectation is the right call, and saying so in your report is worth more to us than a number we would have had to invent.

Two things you already hold do most of the work the missing data would have done. Section 2 of OPS-04 requires a minimum two-week buffer on the order-by date for any supplier with a documented history of late delivery. Both Vietnam suppliers qualify on the evidence in your own file, which makes that buffer our standard rather than an assumption you invented. And sections 4 through 6 of the Song Hong master terms tell you what a promised date is worth here: a good-faith estimate, no liability for capacity, inspection, or ocean-freight delay, and no remedy beyond cancelling before dispatch.

The capacity disclosure you cite is Song Hong's own statement about Song Hong's own facility. Cite it as that. It is evidence of what they told us, which is a different and more defensible thing than evidence of what will happen.

R-16. The Active Shorts purchase order

Granted. The answer is worse than the request assumed.

First, why the file looks empty. The shipment extract we sent you contains no Denver rows at all. Read the Destination_Store column: 96 rows across twelve other stores, and Denver on none of them. It is other-store history, pulled July 14. Denver purchase orders live in our procurement system and were never going to appear in that file, so the absence of an Active Shorts order there is not evidence in either direction. Appendix C is the Denver opening buy as it actually stands.

Second, what has been ordered. Bamboo Joggers are on SH-2291, 950 units, ordered July 24, promised October 3, and you already hold that confirmation. Classic Tee was ordered on August 26 against an August 28 date; you did not have that confirmation, so its terms are in Appendix C. EcoFleece Hoodie has not been ordered, and its order-by date is September 12, which is four days from today.

Third, the Active Shorts. No order was placed. The August 13 date passed without one. It was not deferred, it was not cancelled, and it was not a judgment about how shorts sell in a Denver November. It was missed. Nobody here caught it until you asked, and you found it by noticing an absence, which is harder than finding an error.

Fourth, what has not changed. The launch assortment is four SKUs. We are not revisiting it, and the November date does not reopen it. Do not plan a three-SKU floor, and do not read our silence on the shorts as a decision to drop them.

Fifth, the transaction you could not reconcile. TXN-9118, \$16,668.82 to Mekong Textile Co., coded to Opening buy - focus SKUs and still pending, is not a purchase order and does not evidence one. You were right that it does not reconcile to 1,200 units at \$22.00. A commitment sitting on our finance side with no purchase order behind it on our operations side is a control gap. Name it.

What we need from you rather than from ourselves. At a 60-day lead time, an order placed today lands after the doors are open. The options are not equal and we are not going to choose between them for you. R-03 already put up to \$7,000 behind expedited freight on Jennifer's written approval. Mekong's minimum order quantity is 300 units. The required in-store date is October 19. Tell us what the Denver floor looks like on November 1, what it costs to get there, and what you would give up.

R-17. Store address and receiving on October 19

Granted. Both halves.

The address, the dock, and the receiving constraints are in Appendix E. Put the address on the purchase orders and the carton labels before anything ships.

On receiving before completion, R-01 already answers the part that worried you, and it is worth repeating because it removes a blocker you do not actually have. The space accepts inventory on October 13, a week before the committed completion date, because racking and the secure stockroom finish ahead of the finishes. Receiving does not wait on the punch list. October 19 is six days after we can take goods, not one day before there is anywhere to put them.

On the eight-week case, what slips at the top of the bid range is finishes, signage installation, and punch list. Racking and the secure area are early-sequence work and they hold. The October 13 acceptance date survives an eight-week build. What does not survive it is the opening. That is the risk worth writing up, and it is a different risk from the one you filed.

OPS-04 requires every carton inspected within 24 hours of arrival. The stockroom is powered, lit, and secured from October 13, and delivery windows are available from that date. Whether anyone is on payroll to do the inspecting on October 19 is a staffing question, and R-14 is where that lands.

Still open

The rent commencement request. It came up in a working session in round one and never reached us as a request. Rent commences October 31 under the executed lease, one day before the doors open and not aligned to them. This was the last round in which asking would have changed anything.

Neither marketing team filed in round two, and Marketing B has not filed at all. That is not a problem in itself. It becomes one at the first number in your report that you cannot source and never asked us about.

The \$29,300 sitting in Opening buy - catalog SKUs. Nobody has asked about it in either round. We told you at the outset not to plan, budget, or market the four catalog-only SKUs for Denver, and our own budget carries a line that looks like it does one of those things. It is the kind of thing a client hopes its consultants notice without being told.

Where this leaves us

Fifty-four days. One purchase order that should have gone out four weeks ago, one that has to go out this week, a pay rate that is under the market we benchmarked against, and a landlord charging us rent the day before anyone walks in. None of that is news to you now, because you asked for it.

What we need next is not another question. It is a recommendation we can act on, in language Marcus will follow and with arithmetic Jennifer will check. Bring us the version you would defend.

— Jeff

GreenThreads · Denver opening

Appendix C

Denver opening buy, purchase order status as of September 8, 2026

SKU	Units	PO	Ordered	Promised in store	Status
Classic Tee GT-TEE-01	1,600	DO-7714	Aug 26, 2026	Oct 10, 2026	Confirmed by Delta Organics. \$22,800 at cost. Confirmation not previously sent to you.
Active Shorts GT-SHT-02	1,200	None	Not placed	None	Order-by date of August 13 passed without an order. See R-16.
Bamboo Joggers GT-JOG-03	950	SH-2291	Jul 24, 2026	Oct 3, 2026	Confirmed by Song Hong Apparel. \$28,500 at cost. You hold the confirmation.
EcoFleece Hoodie GT-HOD-04	850	None	Not placed	None	Order-by date is September 12, 2026. Still open. Four days.

Promised dates are supplier estimates under section 4 of the master terms, not guarantees, and no remedy attaches to a missed one. The required in-store date for all four SKUs is October 19, 2026, per R-01. Denver purchase orders live in our procurement system and do not appear in the shipment extract, which covers other stores and was pulled July 14.

Appendix D

HR budget lines, Denver

Budget line	Budgeted	Committed to Jul 14	Remaining
Recruiting & job boards	\$9,000.00	\$3,642.88	\$5,357.12
Pre-opening payroll	\$38,000.00	\$6,632.80	\$31,367.20
Training	\$11,000.00	\$5,822.42	\$5,177.58
Uniforms	\$7,000.00	\$1,460.46	\$5,539.54
Total	\$65,000.00	\$17,558.56	\$47,441.44

Committed figures are the sum of the HR rows in the spend extract, through the July 14 pull. Ten HR transactions appear in it and three of them are still unpaid, totalling \$3,737.12, so committed and paid are not the same number. Nothing after July 14 is reflected. The contingency reserve is a Finance line and is not included here.

Appendix E

Store address and receiving

Item	Detail
Ship-to address	GreenThreads Denver, 2848 E 2nd Avenue, Suite 120, Denver, CO 80206
Store reference	Store #13. Label every carton with the ship-to address, the store number, and the PO number.
Dock	Rear alley bay, single truck, shared with two neighboring tenants. Deliveries by appointment only.
Vehicle limit	The alley will not take a 53-foot trailer. Anything larger breaks at a local cross-dock, which adds a day and a cost that is not in the budget.
Receiving hours	7:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m., Monday through Friday, from October 13, 2026.
Stockroom	Ground floor, same level as the dock. Racking and the secure area complete October 13. Powered, lit, and lockable from that date.
First date goods accepted	October 13, 2026. Per R-01 and Appendix A.
Required in-store date	October 19, 2026. Per R-01.

ZIP 80206 sits in the primary zone of the trade area in Appendix B. The address is confirmed for purchase orders, carton labels, and permit correspondence.